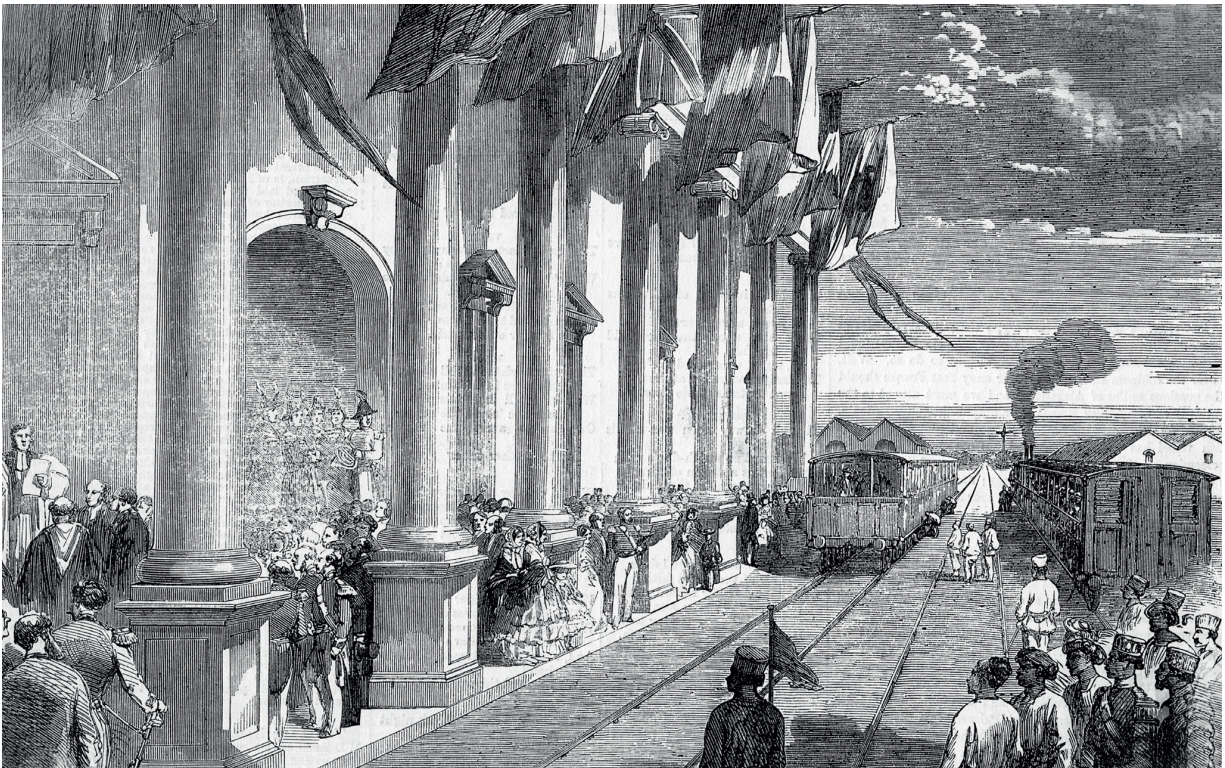


EXPANDING THE WEB

With the successful run of the train from Bori Bunder to Thana, a working blueprint was put in place. It was now time for the pioneers of railways in India to look inwards and lay the lines that would connect the rest of the country.



▲ **This antique print from 1856** shows the opening of the Madras Railway at the Royapuram station, easily recognized by its Corinthian pillars. A bishop can be seen (on the left) offering his blessings.

Engineers were to soon find out that Indian terrains were not easy to subdue. If the west had the plateaus with their impenetrable nooks and crannies and craggy mountains, the east had intricate river systems, some of which turned into untameable torrents during the monsoons.

In the north and the North-West Frontier lay ravines, canyons, and the Himalayas, while Sind and Rajputana offered vast expanses of desert.